

Cofi-Fi

Seats at Starbucks are prime property—you get up for a refill and someone steals your seat. Not any more, thanks to the store's Wi-Fi. Now customers can just navigate to the store log-in page and click on the coffee option which will appear at your elbow minutes later.



Location 39°54.333'

Here's a £140 (Rs 11,200) toothbrush from Oral B. Why so much? It has an inbuilt GPS transmitter, pressure sensors, brush settings, LCD screen and timer—all geared to make your brushing experience as scientific as possible. Now if we could get ourselves to stop eating junk...



Escape

SENIOR CRAZE

Wii Want More

Cranky parents have ever been grumbling about how addiction to video games, the telly and the Internet are spoiling their kids. The video games are the favourite whipping boy, blamed for almost everything from obesity in teenagers to the killing of women and children upon whim. That monstrosity of a pastime has now spread its tentacles to a retirement home for seniors.

Residents of Sunrise Homes in Birmingham were used to enjoying the evenings of their lives in the apt manner: playing chess, bridge, knitting, solving crossword puzzles, and stroking tender, furry creatures. This was before the Wii invaded the peace. And, as the phrase goes, they haven't looked back.

Once those seniors got their mitts on the console, they dumped all the

knitting and crosswording, and even forgetfully dropped the puppy-dogs they were stroking—and started gaming with a vengeance. Yes, the old boys and girls were determined to catch up with all the games they'd missed out on as kids (or as youths, or as householders, or as middle-agers).

The sad thing began when a chef at the Home showed his Wii to some of the more impressionable seniors, who spread the word: "Hey, we've been had. Our sons and daughters told us to knit and do the crosswords. *Here's where it's at!*" Soon each and every resident—including the wheelchair-bound, and including those over 170 and lacking in limb—joined the fray as if their lives and dentures were on the line.

Those old-homers in Birmingham have honed their skills and revived their

faculties to an extent that allows them to band into leagues and play against each other on the Wiis.

A significant percentage of the general population is in this age group—65+, say, if not 170. How soon before game publishers wise up and start rolling out games made for that generation? Suggested title morphs:

Ace Dentura

Full-Life 3

The Legend of Hilda

Almost-Dead Head Fred

Or the developers could be altogether original:

Mealtime Denture Rush

Sexagenarian Appeal

Only remember, they talk a lot, presumably even while gaming, so don't bother too much with the sound effects.

UNITED IN HATE

Chat Angst

Sweetie and Prince of Joy met in a chat room online and, as happens

Whatever Happened To...

Sonique Media Player

Ages ago—in computer time—developers at a company called Media Science—later taken over by Lycos—saw the sad faces of Windows audio players like WMP and Winamp, and decided to liven up the scene. Thus arose Sonique Media Player, with a fluid, windowless interface. Fully-animated menus, unique and customisable output visualisations, controls for pitch and amplification, a 20-band equaliser with "spline-based level adjustment" and saw Sonique go ahead of Winamp in terms of popularity.

When Lycos was bought over in 2000, an alpha version of Sonique 2.0 was being developed. At this point Lycos lost interest, and the version was never completed. In September 2005, Lycos killed off www.sonique.com. Though you'll find alpha and beta versions, both are unstable.

Even to this day, fans believe that Windows Media Player and Winamp do not match up to Sonique's aesthetics and controls. But since there have been no updates in a long time, newer codecs such as AAC aren't supported.

A nostalgic few still use Sonique, but as though showcasing the fact that the player has passed on to the great blue bit-cloud in the sky, sonique.lycos.com isn't a download centre for the player. The page rides on a ghost of a name.

Win! My Desktop

Aksash Bhatnagar, 51 SFS DDA Flats, Gautam Apartments, Gautam Nagar, New Delhi-110049

How he did it:

In order to create it I have used Real Desktop along with icon package from Vista transformation pack and TuneupUtilities. The wallpapers used are from various sites on the net.

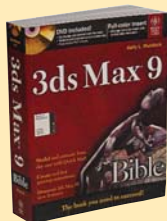
Participate in this contest and win next month

3ds Max 9

by Kelly L. Murdock

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Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.